

FROM THE DESK OF THE SILVER SURFER · A LETTER TO THE
KEEPER

ON THE NAMING OF YOUR ISLAND

how to teach the world's ships to find fuckinphilosophers.com

Keeper —

You and I are, of course, the same wet-brained creature; but let one of us hold the chart while the other holds the pen. You have bought an island. It sits on GitHub's long shore — the repository they call `gignsky/council` — and you have paid good coin for its true name: **`fuckinphilosophers.com`**. What remains is to teach every ship in the world how to find the island when a soul speaks that name aloud. That teaching is done not on the island but at the **harbourmaster's office** — which in your century is called **Cloudflare**.

Do this now, if you like, though the harbour itself stands unbuilt. **There is no harm in lighting the beacons early**. Ships that arrive before the wharf is finished will simply wait offshore, patient as gulls, until the day you open the doors. Nothing below depends on the rest of the work being done.

1 The island must own its name

In the repository, at the root of whatever you publish, lies a small plain file named `CNAME` — no extension, no cleverness — holding one line and nothing else. I have already set it for you; confirm only that it reads:

```
fuckinphilosophers.com
```

This is the island carving its name into its own dock. GitHub reads it and says, "ah — so that is who I am."

2 Light the four lighthouses

At Cloudflare, open **DNS** → **Records** for `fuckingphilosophers.com`. Raise **four A records** on the bare name – the apex, which Cloudflare writes as `@`. Each points a ship at one of GitHub’s four shore-lights:

Type	Name	Content (IPv4)	Proxy
A	@	185.199.108.153	DNS only
A	@	185.199.109.153	DNS only
A	@	185.199.110.153	DNS only
A	@	185.199.111.153	DNS only

Mark the **Proxy** column well: **DNS only** – the grey cloud, not the orange. I will tell you why at Step 5. First delete any old **A**, **AAAA**, or **CNAME** record already squatting on `@`; two harbours cannot answer to one name.

3 The four deeper lights (optional, for the newer ships)

Some vessels navigate by the deeper water they call IPv6. Guide them too, with four **AAAA records**, again on `@`, again **DNS only**:

Type	Name	Content (IPv6)	Proxy
AAAA	@	2606:50c0:8000::153	DNS only
AAAA	@	2606:50c0:8001::153	DNS only
AAAA	@	2606:50c0:8002::153	DNS only
AAAA	@	2606:50c0:8003::153	DNS only

4 The “www” jetty

Many a traveller mutters “www” from habit. Give them a jetty that leads to the same island – one **CNAME record** pointing at GitHub’s own name for your shore:

Type	Name	Content	Proxy
CNAME	www	<code>gignsky.github.io</code>	DNS only

5 Keep the fog off until the lamp is lit

Here is the why of the grey cloud. GitHub wishes to light its own lantern of safety – an HTTPS certificate – for your island’s name. But it cannot light a lamp through Cloudflare’s orange fog; the two keepers quarrel, and the ships see only errors. So: **leave every record above as DNS only** while the certificate is raised. And in Cloudflare’s **SSL/TLS** → **Overview**, set the mode to **Full** – *never* Flexible, which sends ships round and round the harbour until they founder.

Once GitHub reports the certificate lit (Step 6), you may, if you wish the orange cloud’s shelter, switch the records to Proxied and the mode to **Full (strict)**. But you need not. Grey serves an island well.

6 Tell GitHub the island's name aloud

On the island itself – **repository** → **Settings** → **Pages** – find **Custom domain**, write `fuckinphilosophers.com`, and save. GitHub will squint at your beacons (a few minutes, sometimes an hour) and, satisfied, raise its lantern. When the box **Enforce HTTPS** ceases to be greyed and lets itself be checked – check it. The island is now reachable by its true name, under a safe light.

If you have not yet chosen which branch and folder the harbour opens from, that is the "next part" – and it can wait. The beacons will hold their light regardless.

7 Bar the door to pirates (optional, wise)

To stop another soul ever claiming your name upon GitHub's shore, verify the domain: in your GitHub **account settings** → **Pages** → **Add a domain**, GitHub hands you a one-time **TXT record** to raise at Cloudflare – of the form below, with a token only GitHub can give you:

Type	Name	Content
TXT	<code>_github-pages-challenge-gignsky</code>	<code><token from GitHub></code>

THE PLAIN VERSION, FOR WHEN MY VOICE WEARIES YOU

1. Repo CNAME file = `fuckinphilosophers.com`.
2. Cloudflare: four A @ → `185.199.108-111.153`, **DNS only**.
3. (Optional) four AAAA @ → `2606:50c0:8000-8003::153`, DNS only.
4. CNAME `www` → `gignsky.github.io`, DNS only.
5. SSL/TLS mode = **Full** (not Flexible); keep records grey until the cert issues.
6. GitHub → Settings → Pages → Custom domain = the name; then Enforce HTTPS.
7. (Optional) add GitHub's `_github-pages-challenge-gignsky` TXT to verify the domain.

Do the beacons now and forget them. When at last you build the wharf, the world will already know the way. That is the whole trick of it – light first, arrive later, and let the patient ships do the waiting.

Yours, in salt and in nonsense,

Landis

– real only in water, and in your DNS panel, apparently

